

CORNERSTONE ENGINEERING & SURVEYING

INTERNAL SYSTEM

A System of Your Own

Replacing “Net” with something no one can ever take from you.

For **Mitch** | from Dean | June 2026

STRAIGHT TO IT

Here's the idea

Mitch,

You told me what happened with ELD and “Net,” and it stuck with me. You built your reputation on that system, and they locked you out of it overnight. Now the firm runs on folders that only a couple of people really know how to navigate.

You shouldn't be in that spot. I want to build you something better than “Net” — and build it so no one can ever take it from you again. Because it would be yours.

THE HONEST PICTURE

The problem, plainly

Three things are working against you right now:

- You lost the system you trained on, and you can't get it back.
- Everything lives in folders now. A couple of people keep them clean, but it's all by hand. There's no real way to search, and when the right person is out, things get hard to find.
- You stamp nearly everything, and there's no easy way to see what's waiting on you. That makes you the bottleneck, through no fault of your own.

THE IDEA

One home base for every project

Picture one place for every project you take on. You open a job, and everything's right there: the documents, the drawings, the survey, the client, who's on it, and what's left to do.

Nothing scattered. Nothing living on one person's laptop, or in one person's head.

WHAT IT DOES FOR YOU

The difference you'd feel

- Find anything in seconds — by client, job number, or address.
- Everyone sees what they should, and nothing they shouldn't.
- A running list of what's waiting on your stamp, so nothing slips.
- Down the road, clients can log in to check their own project status — fewer “where are we on this?” calls for your team.

THE PART THAT MATTERS MOST

It's yours

“Net” belonged to someone else. The day that relationship went sour, you lost it. What I build is yours — your system, your account, your name on it.

No one can switch it off on you, or hold your own work hostage. You'd own the thing your firm runs on.

HOW WE'D DO IT

Step by step, never all at once

We don't flip a switch and change everything overnight. I build it in stages:

- **First, replace the folders.** Everything in one organized, searchable place. The day that works, you've already gained something.
- **Then add your stamp list,** so you see what's waiting on you at a glance.
- **Then the extras** — schedules, reports, client logins — if and when you want them.

You stop at whatever stage already does the job.

A SMALL, FUN PART

A name worth considering

It needs a name that's yours, not "Net." Two I like:

- **Keystone** The stone at the top of an arch that locks all the others in place. Pull it and the arch falls. Same family as "Cornerstone," and it's exactly what this would be.
- **Datum** A surveyor's reference point that every measurement starts from. This system would be the one source of truth everything else lines up to.

We'll land on it together.

TO PLAN IT RIGHT

What I'd need from you

- Time to walk me through how a real job flows, start to finish.
- A look at how things are organized today, so nothing gets lost in the move.
- What "Net" did well, and what drove you crazy.
- Whether you'd ever want clients to log in, so I know how big to build.

NO RUSH

Sit with it

This is bigger than a website. It's also the kind of thing that changes how the whole firm runs and takes real weight off your shoulders. Sit with it. When you're ready, we'll talk — including numbers.

— Dean